Zoledronic acid · adjuvant breast treatment

Zoledronic acid by intravenous (IV) infusion once every six months for up to five years, unless progression or unacceptable toxicity changes the plan. The usual source dose is 4 mg, with renal review before prescribing.

Make treatment fit into daily life

The infusion itself runs over at least 15 minutes. Preparation, blood review and observation make the visit longer. A port or take-home infusion pump is not routinely required for this medicine alone.

Before an infusion

Blood results, dental issues, supplements and current medicines are reviewed. The clinic confirms whether treatment can proceed.

In the unit

A peripheral cannula is often sufficient. The infusion is at least 15 minutes; ask about the full visit length.

Between infusions

Continue the prescribed supplements and dental care. Six-month spacing does not mean new symptoms should wait until the next visit.

Planning completion

The source allows up to five years. Confirm the individual duration and continuing endocrine/bone-health plan.

Who arranges each check?

Agree the due window, booking team, result reviewer and whom to contact if an appointment or result is missing. This reference page does not book or record a test.

Sources and review

The NCCP regimen supplies the treatment rules. Separate guidelines supply the longer-term monitoring recommendations, with their qualifications retained.

- NCCP 00545 v3 · official regimen
- ESMO 2024 early breast cancer guideline · treatment and follow-up
- ESC 2022 cardio-oncology guideline · cardiac surveillance and risk
- HSE · chemotherapy side effects and urgent advice
- NICE NG101 · bone health and follow-up
- NOGG · section 7, aromatase inhibitors and fracture risk
- eviQ · implanted port patient information
- eviQ · peripherally inserted central catheter (PICC) patient information
- NCCP NCIS antiemetics v8 (2025), Table 1
- ASCO · biomarkers in metastatic breast cancer
- ESMO metastatic breast cancer guideline · 2026

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending